SLEEP

How much sleep people need, how to set up the bedroom, a wind-down routine, and a two-week sleep diary.

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GUIDE / VERIFY: General wellness information, not medical advice. It does not replace care from a doctor, nurse, pharmacist or other qualified professional. **Talk to your health-care provider before starting a new exercise, diet or health plan, especially if you have a medical condition.**

1. HOW MUCH SLEEP?

AGE	RECOMMENDED SLEEP PER 24 HOURS
Adults 18 and older	**7 hours or more**
Teens 13 to 18	8 to 10 hours
Children 6 to 12	9 to 12 hours
Children 3 to 5	10 to 13 hours, including naps
Children 1 to 2	11 to 14 hours, including naps

Poor sleep affects mood, memory, judgment, reaction time and long-term health. Drowsy driving is as dangerous as drunk driving: if you're nodding off, pull over.

2. THE BEDROOM

- ☐ **Dark:** blackout curtains or an eye mask; cover or turn away glowing lights.
- ☐ **Quiet:** earplugs, or a fan or white-noise machine to cover sounds.
- ☐ **Cool:** a cooler room is easier to sleep in. Use layers you can kick off.
- ☐ **Comfortable:** a mattress and pillow that don't leave you sore.
- ☐ **For sleep:** keep work, TV and screens out of bed.
- ☐ **Clock out of sight:** watching the time makes it harder to fall asleep.

3. HABITS AND ROUTINE

DURING THE DAY

- Get up at the **same time every day**, weekends too. This is the most powerful habit of all.
- Get outdoor light in the morning.
- Be active during the day, but finish hard exercise a few hours before bed.
- Limit caffeine after early afternoon.
- Keep naps short (under 30 minutes) and before mid-afternoon.

THE LAST HOUR

- Dim the lights; put phones and screens away.
- Do the same calm things in the same order: wash up, read, stretch, breathe. *(WL-07)*
- Avoid big meals and alcohol close to bedtime. Alcohol makes sleep lighter later in the night.
- Write tomorrow's to-do list so it isn't running through your head.
- Can't sleep after about 20 minutes? Get up, do something quiet in dim light, and go back when sleepy.

TALK TO YOUR PROVIDER if you snore loudly or someone sees you stop breathing in your sleep (possible sleep apnea), if you're very sleepy in the day despite enough time in bed, or if trouble sleeping lasts more than a few weeks. Insomnia and sleep apnea are common and treatable.

4. MY SLEEP PLAN

Wake-up time (every day): _____ **Screens off by:** _____

Lights out: _____ **Last caffeine by:** _____

My wind-down routine: _____

5. TWO-WEEK SLEEP DIARY

DATE	BEDTIME	TIME TO FALL ASLEEP	TIMES AWAKE	WAKE TIME	CAFFEINE / ALCOHOL	HOW RESTED (1-5)	NOTES

SOURCES / FURTHER REFERENCE

1. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention: About Sleep; Sleep Hygiene Tips; Drowsy Driving. cdc.gov/sleep
2. American Academy of Sleep Medicine: Healthy Sleep Habits; sleep duration recommendations. sleepeducation.org
3. National Heart, Lung, and Blood Institute: Sleep Deprivation and Deficiency; Sleep Apnea. nhlbi.nih.gov

IMPORTANT: Don't stop or change sleep medicines without talking to your provider. Bring this diary to your appointment: it helps.